

FAMILY COURT DATA REPORT · STATE SERIES · NO. 28

NORTH CAROLINA
WHAT FAMILIES ARE REPORTING.

Pulled from the Family Rights Registry — a cross-location dataset on what pro se parents are actually experiencing inside North Carolina's family courts and child-welfare system.

236

NORTH CAROLINA FAMILIES ON RECORD · 431 CHILDREN IMPACTED · 18 MONTHS MEDIAN MONTHS LOST OF PARENTING TIME

DATA AS OF
OCTOBER 21, 2026

COUNTIES REPRESENTED
67 OF 100

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01 NAMED COURT ACTORS · NORTH CAROLINA

A name appears below only after 3 or more independent families have named the same actor in North Carolina. Submitter names, emails, and contact details are never published. Comments below are direct family reports — one per family — with all identifying information removed.

Shy-Kendra Lawson

CPS WORKER · LENOIR · **6 SUBMISSIONS**

> *"Shy-Kendra Lawson delayed reunification and failed to properly support kinship placement despite an approved relative option and my continued requests for my children to be safely placed with family. Cleaner, stronger version for the form, because apparently forms want trauma squeezed into one tiny bureaucratic sentence: Shy-Kendra Lawson delayed reunification, failed to support approved kinship placement, and contributed to my children remaining in foster care instead of being placed with safe family."*

> *"Made or relied on false and misleading claims, ignored evidence in my favor, and supported keeping my child in foster care."*

> *"Delayed reunification by interfering with visitation and failing to support reasonable family placement options."* LENOIR COUNTY SOCIAL SERVICES

> *"Lied under oath, not following guidelines set beforehand"*

> *"Told me lies, laughed at me humiliated me several times"*

> *"Great experience. Would recommend."*

Create Complaint Packet: https://my.standwithmeg.com/reports/actors/nc-shy-kendra-lawson/complaint-packet
Family-reported pattern context only. Each person must file only their own truthful, first-hand complaint using their own facts, dates, evidence, orders, transcripts, and documents.

Tammy Smith

ATTORNEY (OPPOSING) · HARNETT · **6 SUBMISSIONS**

> *"She was texting the judge from a personal number during the hearing about the hearing itself. He would check his phone after every single text she sent in the court room. And they would lock eyes and nod."*

> *"Refused to make copies (in the chambers) of evidence that the trial judge Rose asked, continued to question myself about My spouse but would not subpoena My spouse to ask the questions."* HARNETT COUNTY

> *"Weird stuff going on in this county with this lawyer and judge Kimble. The case showed obvious partiality towards Tammy and her client."*

> *"Delay after delay. Inappropriate with the judge"* HARNETT COUNTY

> *"Inappropriate relationship with the judge."*

> *"Babs sndjdbd Anshan Anshan"*

Create Complaint Packet: https://my.standwithmeg.com/reports/actors/nc-tammy-smith/complaint-packet
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01 NAMED COURT ACTORS, CONTINUED

Cindy Cronkhite

GAL / CHILD REPRESENTATIVE · LENOIR COUNTY COURTHOUSE · **5 SUBMISSIONS**

> *"Provided or relied on false and misleading information while ignoring evidence supporting reunification and my relationship with my child. Appeared to favor the foster placement while minimizing my parental bond, my evidence, and reunification efforts. Cindy failed to fully investigate my child's best interests, ignored key evidence, and supported continued separation from me."*

> *"Submitted reports and recommendations that ignored key evidence supporting reunification, including my negative drug screens, approved kinship placement, and concerns about visits being suspended. Cindy Cronkhite failed to include important facts in GAL reports, did not support safe family placement, and contributed to continued separation from my children."*

> *"Nothing she has done has been in the best interest of the children, she has kept the mother from seeing her girls as well as been untruthful"*

> *"Supported agency recommendations that limited reunification, visitation, and family placement efforts."*

> *"Lied under oath, deprived mothers visits."* LENOIR

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01 NAMED COURT ACTORS, CONTINUED

Duchess Chance CONTINUED 1 / 2

GAL / CHILD REPRESENTATIVE · BEAUFORT COUNTY · **5 SUBMISSIONS**

> *"She was my GAL. I reported abuse to her which she did nothing about. I reported my money was being held by DSS from my job and she did nothing. I reported Abby Williams making me write a statement she was giving and spelling words for me and she did nothing. I told her the truth about my parents and why I kept trying to go home to them but it was never reported. She wouldn't allow me to see my siblings. She came to locked facilities I was in and told me I had to stay because there was no where else for me but there was. I had more family in WV willing to take me. I was also 17. She allowed dss to keep me out of school which delayed my graduation and threw me behind. She lied on her court report stating she saw and spoke with me each week and I barely saw her or spoke to her. She told a judge it wasn't in my best interest to speak with him and tried to quash my subpoena to testify from my mother's attorney when I specifically kept asking to speak with a judge. She at one point told me I was nothing but trouble to her."*

> *"Falsified her reports to the judge. Did not visit or talk with the children as reported. Allowed children's visits with abuser to continue even after she struck children on several occasions and children were refusing visits she made them attend stating it is an order and you and your dad will be in trouble with the judge if you do not go. She allowed contact with siblings to be severely restricted. She allowed one child's paydays to go to the social worker with him never seeing those wages again. She did not show up to juvenile court when child had ran away from abusive placement and dss was trying to have him charged for disorderly conduct. She did not help in getting his picture released to search for him. She did no advocacy for the children. She and lead social workers are friends and do a podcast online about wine outside of work. She was not neutral. She also did not respect DVPO in place with the parents."* BEAUFORT COUNTY

01 NAMED COURT ACTORS, CONTINUED

Duchess Chance CONTINUED 2 / 2

GAL / CHILD REPRESENTATIVE · BEAUFORT COUNTY · **5 SUBMISSIONS**

> *"She only becomes involved and advocates when it is convenient for her. Contradicted herself multiple times on whether removals impact children dependent on what fits the current narrative. Does not advocate independently but clearly makes recommendations in conjunction with DSS. Even if it is not in the best interest of the child."*

> *"Lied to my children repeatedly. Participated in letting my daughter think I didn't want her home. Said she only "has" to speak to my children once every 90 days. Has hung up on my grandmother before and me as well. Her GAL reports are filled with lies and inconsistencies."* BEAUFORT

> *"Believe everything child said"*

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01 NAMED COURT ACTORS, CONTINUED

Jason Kimble

JUDGE · HARNETT COUNTY · **5 SUBMISSIONS**

> *"He dragged the case out over months and months because he kept claiming he didn't have time to listen to the testimonies. It cost our family tens of thousands of dollars. He claimed he lost his notes and extended the case yet another day for the father to say his piece all over again. Pushed and pushed his decision as far as he possible could. The father had zero case against the mother. All his accusations were proved false. The entire thing was weird and suspicious and showed favoritism towards the father. Justice was not served. Seemed the entire time the judge did not give a care at all about the case."* HARNETT

> *"Very inappropriate comments during the trial. He joked about himself not knowing when to stop drinking alcohol - knowing that he was arrested for a DUI from picking up his kids from school. He also was talking inappropriately with the attorney - he allowed heresay numerous times for her client. Didn't ask for proof. Discarded all evidence of her client being abusive and neglected to make a ruling several times until it was far enough out to claim comfort."*

> *"Ruled on emergency ex parte, never had an emergency hearing. Took my son from me with no evidence Made a ruling with no evidence. Left child with abuser. Took months and months to make a ruling on emergency ex parte order"*

> *"Took entirely too long to rule on an emergency case."* HARNETT

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01 NAMED COURT ACTORS, CONTINUED

Jennifer Eichorn

COURT CLERK / COURT STAFF · LENOIR COUNTY COURTHOUSE RECOVERY COURT COORDINATOR · **5 SUBMISSIONS**

> *"Jennifer Eichorn provided questionable drug test documentation, including a positive result before a sample was submitted, which affected my visitation. She lied on a lot of parents and treated them badly."*

> *"Presented a positive drug test result before I gave a urine sample, causing my visitation and reunification progress to be harmed."*

> *"Provided disputed positive drug test results that were used to delay reunification and prevent family restoration."*

> *"coordinator for recovery court falsified drug tests to prevent parents from reunification with their children"* LENOIR COUNTY

> *"Saying I got to do group twice a week"*

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01 NAMED COURT ACTORS, CONTINUED

Jonathon Sargeant

JUDGE · LENOIR COUNTY COURTHOUSE · **5 SUBMISSIONS**

> *"Judge Johnathan Sargeant ignored my due process concerns and allowed the case to proceed without fully addressing pending constitutional, ADA, visitation, and placement issues. Judge Johnathan Sargeant laughed at me in open court with the GAL attorney and CPS attorney while comments were made in front of the courtroom audience suggesting I did not know who my children's fathers were, despite the fact that I had provided that information. He laughed during my hearing with opposing attorneys after they made a humiliating statement about my children's fathers, then failed to meaningfully hear my evidence and due process concerns."*

> *"Ignored evidence, denied due process, prevented reunification without evidence Ignored evidence, went along with whatever CPS claimed without giving me a chance to defend myself, no due process."*

> *"Judge Jonathan Sargeant failed to meaningfully address evidence, due process concerns, DSS misconduct, visitation issues, and reunification efforts, allowing my child to remain in foster care."* LENOIR

> *"Denied motion, laughed claiming I did not know who my child's father was, denied kinship allowing them to stay in CPS custody after ICPC was approved"* LENOIR COUNTY

> *"Laughed at mother in middle of court over paternity issues, doing whatever dss suggests without reason."* LENOIR

Create Complaint Packet: https://my.standwithmeg.com/reports/actors/nc-jonathon-sargeant/complaint-packet
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01 NAMED COURT ACTORS, CONTINUED

Latesha Boseman CONTINUED 1 / 2

CPS WORKER · BEAUFORT · **5 SUBMISSIONS**

> *"She had me placed in locked facilities without a court order because I wanted to speak to a judge and kept running away from bad homes they placed me in. She refused to report the abuse in the last facility I was in. She took my paydays from my job and I never received the funds back. She cancelled my dental surgery 3 times so almost a year later when my mom could get it done I had curved roots around my jaw and had to be cut more with a longer recovery time. She lied to me saying my family didn't want to see me. She wouldn't allow me to go to my church in the community. She wouldn't allow me to see my siblings. She frequently would take my personal belongings, many of which I've never gotten back, esp my cellphone. She would t allow me to go to my family in WV even tho I was wanted there. She lied on the stand about my behaviors. She lied on the stand saying I never told her I wanted to go home and stated I was afraid of my father. I watched her get really close to my mother when she told Latesha you will not speak to my son that way and Latesha told her what are you going to do about it? He's in our custody and he will do what we say. She would allow me to have no contact even with mys school or peers when I was telling of the abuse in the places she put me. That's when I was moved to a facility out of my community 2 hours away and taken from school completely with no schooling being done."*

01 NAMED COURT ACTORS, CONTINUED

Latesha Boseman CONTINUED 2 / 2

CPS WORKER · BEAUFORT · **5 SUBMISSIONS**

> *"Falsified reports to GAL and judge. Placed one son in facilities without a court order. Restricted access to children with parents, family, and siblings. Took personal possessions from children. Took paydays of one teenage son which he has never seen to this day. Perjured herself on the stand regarding missing son and efforts made and he came to be in a facility with no court order. Followed and stalked our family. Got physically aggressive with me personally saying and what are you gonna do about it? Refused to follow the court order and restricted parents access to medical and educational records, events, Dr appts, and had medication changed without parents knowledge or consent. Refused to follow a DVPO in place making parents be in a room with their abuser and not respecting the fear and concerns they had with the abuser. Placed children with abuser when visits were reported of going badly to the point social Workers had to intervene and children tried to refuse visits and she made them go anyway. Children were struck at visits with their mother but visits were not stopped nor did social worker do anything to the mother."*

> *"She has proven to be very power hungry. Has admitted that she does not like children, publicly. It is abundantly clear that she acts out of emotion and malice, and not professionally. In turn, this becomes priority, not the welfare of the children. She does not act in their best interest."*

> *"Has a record that entails she should be nowhere near making decisions for the well-being of children. Has enabled the abuse of Audrey Faith Bell (social worker). Also lied to my 15 year old daughter regarding her coming home."*

> *"Supervisor of foster care that has multiple criminal offenses including armed robbery and domestic violence."*

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01 NAMED COURT ACTORS, CONTINUED

Lori Leggett

CPS WORKER · BEAUFORT · **5 SUBMISSIONS**

> *"She is the director. I kept asking to speak to someone because I wasn't allowed to see my family at all. She also told me my family did not wish to see me right now and no one was willing to take me. I later found this to not be true as many family members, my girlfriend, and even my friends had asked to see me and some to take me in. I also told her what Abby Williams had wrote and said in court was not true and she just kept saying I know her and she would not lie. It's like it didn't matter what I said. Lori Leggett is also who made me go to the first locked facility saying it was there or she would go for a petition to have me placed in juvie. I reported the abuse to her also at one facility and she did nothing. I also told her I did not like sleeping in their office and their couches weren't even long enough to hold me and she said I could always make a bed on the floor. She does not care."*

> *"There is a gross lack of oversight based on her lack of knowledge of decisions and actions being taken by her own employees. When challenged she hides behind very general statements vs. taking accountability for their actions."*

> *"She's the director. She has been stealing children for 25 years now, I will run out of room in this box to name everything she has allowed to happen."*

> *"Signed off on paperwork and acts like she has no knowledge of title 4e and 4d funding"* BEAUFORT COUNTY

> *"No license ingores us"* BEAUFORT COUNTY

Create Complaint Packet: https://my.standwithmeg.com/reports/actors/nc-lori-leggett/complaint-packet
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01 NAMED COURT ACTORS, CONTINUED

Ward Scott

JUDGE · BUNCOMBE · **5 SUBMISSIONS**

> *"Ward exhibited clear bias from the inception of the case; sustained every objection to all my evidence of harm and trauma caused to my children by their father, then told me, "Looks like you have no evidence of any of this. I find you unbelievable," threatened to imprison me if I did not reveal the name of my attorney who advised me to flee this jurisdiction to keep my boys safe, then decided I was lying when I refused to give him the name; violates many of the Rules of Judicial Procedure but threatened to sanction me when I pointed this out; pretended not to understand what a conflict of interest was, and decided that the wisest action to take to determine the existence of a conflict was for *the conflicted person* to make this determination; withheld that he had a conflict of interest due to his former employment with NC's DSS, even after I mentioned numerous times that DSS behaved unethically and perhaps illegally, and that I've been told that DSS is trying to harm me; has a fantastical ego that is a major danger to anyone entering family court in Buncombe County, particularly if you are a woman and your children have suffered abuse caused by a man."*

> *"Terminated my parental rights and they called me to court that morning without notice and I was in class at the local technical College not sure why I wasn't informed on this hearing that I knew NOTHING ABOUT"*

> *"He laughed when he saw an evidence photo of a hole punched in a door by my ex, then looked at my ex and said “you know they make keys, don’t you?”"*

> *"Ignored Evidence"*

Create Complaint Packet: https://my.standwithmeg.com/reports/actors/nc-ward-scott/complaint-packet
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01 NAMED COURT ACTORS, CONTINUED

Abigail Williams

CPS WORKER · BEAUFORT · **4 SUBMISSIONS**

> *"She yelled at my mother at the hospital telling her she was an irresponsible mother and didn't deserve her children. She refused to leave my hospital room until the Dr made her when I was throwing an absolute fit. This was before any safety plan or order done. She made me leave my mother that night even tho I just wanted to go home. Two days later she wouldn't let me leave a room at DSS until I finished writing a statement which she was telling me what to write and gave spelling for words as I struggle. That letter was also back dated by two days. She lied in the order she got signed by Regina Parker. She has statements in there I never said. She would not allow me to see my family at all for a month. Then it was only my mother even tho I asked for my dad and siblings. She told me my family did not want to see me and I found out later that was a lie and my family both close and in WV had reach out to see and speak with me as well as my girlfriend."*

> *"She threatened me while at the hospital with my son. Refused to leave his room even when asked. Yelled at me in front of my son and hospital staff. (Recorded) Falsified her records to obtain non secured custody. Laughed in court when I asked that they show evidence because I was due a 7-10 hearing and they had continued it and never had to show any proof. Approached my teenage son telling him I was a horrible parent and not meeting his needs. Spoke with our pastor telling it was proven we were abusive parents. Spoke with our children's school telling them they were forbidden to speak with us as we had no rights to our children at this time."* BEAUFORT COUNTY

> *"Perjury and lied to have my kids removed a out the condition of my house. Worked with the town to have my utilities cut off so she could remove my kids. Dss never stepped foot in my home to confirm the condition of my home She also tried to have a surgery preformed on my son who is a cardiac paitient without the approval of his cardiologist"*

> *"She perjured herself many times on the stand. Lied during intake, has lied repeatedly. There are MANY families she has wronged."*

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01 NAMED COURT ACTORS, CONTINUED

Daphne Bacon

GAL / CHILD REPRESENTATIVE / ATTORNEY / GAL / CHILD REPRESENTATIVE · BEAUFORT · **4 SUBMISSIONS**

> *"She never spoke with any of the children but was a supervisor who began to attend meetings in Duchess Chances place when I began to complain she was not speaking up for the children nor visiting with them or respecting the DVPO in place with the parents. She told me all I did was cause chaos around me (recorded) after I was placed in a waiting room alone with my abuser. She stated until you are done what you are told you will not see your children. This was 7 months in with not a single hearing being had."* BEAUFORT COUNTY

> *"I reported that Duchess Chance was not listening to me and allowing abuse and me to be placed in locked facilities. She didn't report the abuse either. I reported Latesha had taken my money from my job yet it was never returned. I reported my cellphone had been taken and I wasn't allowed to talk to my family I reported I wanted to see my family but she did nothing to help and said she was told they didn't want to see me. It was all untrue. They tried to isolate me."*

> *"Never advocated. Then at a crucial point where advocacy was needed she did not do so. When challenged in oversight she has a very adversarial return and does not act appropriately or in a professional manner."*

> *"Followed me to my car during open court and took pictures of the vehicle."*

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H. Jay White, Sr.

ATTORNEY · CABARRUS COUNTY · **4 SUBMISSIONS**

> *"Says things that aren't true and is either allowing DSS to lie or telling them to lie . He's the most powerful man in Cabarrus County no one will go against him. He's asking me to stop taking my prescribed medication that I've been taking for over 20 years and the foster mom is on the same medication and is allowed to care for our children but he's stating I can't."*

> *"He represents all Dhs cases and still does and he lies and falsified papers"* CABBARUS COUNTY

> *"https://recorder.google.com/d429d183-e30f-4023-b14a-f071dafe0a70"*

> *"Withheld evidence"* CABARRUS

Create Complaint Packet: https://my.standwithmeg.com/reports/actors/nc-h-jay-white-sr/complaint-packet
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01 NAMED COURT ACTORS, CONTINUED

Jason Williams

JUDGE · BEAUFORT COUNTY · **4 SUBMISSIONS**

> *"I want to start by saying I think this man was trying to work the good ol boy system to bring about change and fight for parents the best way he knew how within that system. I think advocating for me and parents like me is what cost him his judges seat in the last election. That being said he still signed orders that were unconstitutional and allowed in lies without the parents ever getting to speak or present evidence. He allowed us to be silenced and blocked. He allowed delays. He allowed full hearings against my teenage son without my son ever being notified or present knowing my son ran claiming abuse. He allowed back door meetings in his chambers without us as parents being represented or our children. He did give unlimited visitation with our parents present and all rights to appointments to be present and have records and our children to be able to contact one another freely. He had a responsibility though to say it was illegal and abolish it but he chose not to. He did so trying to hold that seat n still lost it because he was playing both sides."*

> *"He would accept no proof or documentation from my mother. He violated due process and kept continuing hearings for DSS. In my juvenile case started by DSS he held full hearings without me being present or notified. He signed an order for my property ordering that my mother get this items or be jailed. He refused to investigate my claims of abuse at the facility I ran from. He turned a blind eye to me being placed in locked facilities without reason because I was speaking out about the care I received and the abuse. He did not report that abuse either to the authorities."*

> *"At the time he was my court appointed attorney. Failed to file any motions and misrepresenton"*

> *"He signed and reinforced the unconstitutional seizure of my children, after the fact."*

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01 NAMED COURT ACTORS, CONTINUED

Kaaneetha Morning

CPS WORKER · LENOIR · **4 SUBMISSIONS**

> *"Kaaneetha likes to degrade families and talk down to them like we are lesser of a person. She tries to turn every situation around to make the parent look bad. Since she became supervisor she hasmade my caseworker Shy-Kendra Lawson stop communicating with me completely and Kaaneetha has stopped all supervised visits with my children without a court order. She is disrespectful and has pushed for adoption and away from reunification since she started a few months ago. The last supervisor got up in the middle of work left everything at his desk, quit, and walked out. I believe that he couldn't go along with the orders he was being pushed to do to me. He had denied my visit on my baby's bday at first and then he called me the morning of my visit to tell me he was going to allow my visit after sleeping on it all night. He had started having compassion near the end and relating with me more and then he got up and just walked out and quit. Suspended my court-ordered visits with my children and told me visits would not resume unless I completed a hair follicle test, despite my prior negative drug screens and no new court order being shown to me. She is so unprofessional and acts ghetto!! Kaaneetha Morning informed me my visits were suspended, which further delayed reunification and caused continued separation from my children. She is really rude and degrades me every chance she gets."*

> *"Restricted my visitation, ignored evidence and concerns I raised, and supported continued separation from my child in foster care. Was rude and tried degrading me every chance she got."*

> *"Li3s, under oath, tampered srugs screena, not baving children's best interests at forefront"*

> *"Saying I cannot been delivering with my daughter and being and cannot get my kids up"*

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01 NAMED COURT ACTORS, CONTINUED

Matthew Jackson CONTINUED 1 / 2

ATTORNEY · BEAUFORT · **4 SUBMISSIONS**

> *"Submitted lies to the judge to obtain a non secured custody order. Gave documentation to him to show he d made an error which he refused to correct because his social workers would not give him false information. Interviewed children without anyone else present. Told my son he would never see me again if he changed his story. Threatened me directly saying I could keep fighting the allegations but I was only making it harder on the children because I would never see them and would be severely restricted in my contact with them, which they did until I got louder and louder and making complaints with the state and making TikTok's. Would not authorize my son's picture to be released to news outlets when he ran away from placement for the 4th time and was missing two months. Help suppress evidence and threatened law enforcement with law suites that were trying to help my son as he claimed physically and sexual assault by the facility he was placed in without a court order."*
>
> BEAUFORT COUNTY

> *"He was the DSS attorney and reported falsely to the judge statements he said I made. Said the workers would not lie and that I was just changing my story now. I told him the statement Abby Williams made me write n that I was in a locked room. He said I just don't believe that but he still submitted that letter as fact. He told a judge I was fearful of my parents and that was a lie. He told a judge there was no one else to take me also a lie proven by many letters my mother has that she submitted to him from herself and my family. He also tried to block me from speaking with the judge."*

> *"Has lied continuously, his court interpretations are quite warped and it's alarming he is still allowed to practice law without a serious psychological evaluation. MANY families have grievances with him. He has enabled the abuse of my children and acts as though he's untouchable. He throws tantrums when the judges don't do exactly what he wants, I've actually seen him storm out of the courtroom and I've also seen him so mad he started to pack up his belongings as the judge was still speaking. I have several pages of complaints against this one."*

01 NAMED COURT ACTORS, CONTINUED

Matthew Jackson CONTINUED 2 / 2

ATTORNEY · BEAUFORT · **4 SUBMISSIONS**

> *"Continues to delay my case. It's been a year without an initial hearing yet."*

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01 NAMED COURT ACTORS, CONTINUED

Regina Parker

JUDGE · BEAUFORT COUNTY · **4 SUBMISSIONS**

> *"She blindly signed nonsecured custody orders for me and my brothers. She would accept none of my mother's proof or documents. When I ran away she signed an order stating she was not requiring house arrest or monitoring but DSS was requesting it and they continued to have custody of me even tho I was 17 and the law says I can stay or go anywhere I feel is safe. My charges for undisciplined youth (running away) was dropped because of this law but that is still wrote in the order. I was led to believe I had been ordered by her and DSS but didn't see this order until I was already 18 as they would not allow me to have a copy of the order. I did ask. Due process was not followed or the law."* BEAUFORT

> *"Signed a non secured custody order after DSS had taken the children but verified none of the statements in the motions nor spoke directly with any social worker or parent. When I made complaints from that time she has refused to touch our case nor hear anything to do with our case after I made a TikTok exposing she signs 94% of all dss orders never verifying one thing or speaking with anyone other than dss attorney Matthew Jackson whom she has close ties with in the community on various projects."*

> *"She's the chief district judge and not only did she lie to me she has enabled this abuse."*

> *"Signed for telephonic signatures after the fact of removal."*

Create Complaint Packet: https://my.standwithmeg.com/reports/actors/nc-regina-parker/complaint-packet
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01 NAMED COURT ACTORS, CONTINUED

Robert S. Pleasant

ATTORNEY · JOHNSTON · **4 SUBMISSIONS**

> *"I was there the entire day for a hearing and got the last five minutes of the day. I gave evidence that I was in the emergency room the day before with my son to prove that I was telling the truth. This attorney just came in there talking about he was in the emergency room with his dad, but was not required to have any proof. He just walked in and said it should be dismissed. The judge looked over the paper and dismissed it without hearing my evidence."*

> *"Opposing counsel represented the children's father throughout the custody and child welfare proceedings. I am including this attorney because of their direct involvement in litigation, motions, court proceedings, and decisions that contributed to the ongoing separation from my children."* FAMILY COURT

> *"Failed to file a motion to modify a pre trial order after consultation with client during mediation resulting in tens of thousands of dollars lost."*

Create Complaint Packet: https://my.standwithmeg.com/reports/actors/nc-robert-s-pleasant/complaint-packet
Family-reported pattern context only. Each person must file only their own truthful, first-hand complaint using their own facts, dates, evidence, orders, transcripts, and documents.

Samantha Keech

CPS WORKER · BEAUFORT · **4 SUBMISSIONS**

> *"She stayed with me some when I had to sleep in the office at DSS. I told her the loveseats weren't long enough for me to sleep and she told me to make a bed on the floor. I also had no breakfast on two occasions and when I asked she said she would get me something soon. Soon was lunch and she d order pizza for lunch and that was also my dinner to. It was like that each time she was with me when I had to stay in the office."*

> *"Heard recording I have and did not investigate anything also acts dumb when it comes to the funding for foster care"* BEAUFORT COUNTY

> *"Sent my 17 year to live with the man that kidnapped him for 10 years"*

> *"She is a supervisor, she has enabled the abuse of my children."*

Create Complaint Packet: https://my.standwithmeg.com/reports/actors/nc-samantha-keech/complaint-packet
Family-reported pattern context only. Each person must file only their own truthful, first-hand complaint using their own facts, dates, evidence, orders, transcripts, and documents.

01 NAMED COURT ACTORS, CONTINUED

Tom Brandon III

ATTORNEY · BEAUFORT · **4 SUBMISSIONS**

> *"Was court appointed but would not take my calls. Told me I messaged him to much. Would not respect my wishes. Would not push the issue of no 7-10 day hearing. Would not push visitation or file a motion for it even tho I asked. Would not attend meetings at DSS with us. Kept pushing me to sign papers for DSS that he did not even review. They would call him in front of me telling me I wouldn't sign assessment of 1. Safety requirements (which had me admitting to changes I needed to make) when I signed and wrote closely beside my name I do not agree with this it was tore up n I was told I would have to do it again not doing that. 2. Giving up my medical rights to my autistic son (I straight refused) I still have all of Mr Brandon's texts and emails and his refusal to represent me as he was only representing Beaufort county dss"* BEAUFORT COUNTY

> *"This was my mother's court appointed attorney she started with. I reach out to him asking him to get me in front of the judge and telling him what they put in the motion with my statements was a lie. I told him of the forced written statement was had to do with Abby Williams in a locked room. He did not submit anything or get me in front of a judge. He would t even prepare a motion for my mother making it known what I had told him so he could fight back for her and for us."*

> *"He has steadily ignored me, refused to file what I've asked, but my biggest issue is he allowed my 15 year old daughter to be interrogated by the dss attorney for the better part of an hour causing her to be quite ill for several days following."*

> *"When I told him about a fight at the visit with the dss worker he told me I was lying even though I had five witnesses to the fight. He is my lawyer and has not filed a single motion on anything. He is suppose to be fighting for me not for dss"*

Create Complaint Packet: https://my.standwithmeg.com/reports/actors/nc-tom-brandon-iii/complaint-packet
Family-reported pattern context only. Each person must file only their own truthful, first-hand complaint using their own facts, dates, evidence, orders, transcripts, and documents.

01 NAMED COURT ACTORS, CONTINUED

Andrea Starkey

CPS WORKER · BEAUFORT COUNTY · **3 SUBMISSIONS**

> *"Told one of my sons he was nothing but a problem and he would continue to be taken further and further from home until he could learn how to listen and do as he was told. (He kept running away to home) She forbid children's after school activities and contact with their siblings. One recording has her forbidding teenage son to go to a basketball game at school with his sister because I said so. You have no authority here she told him. She falsified records to GAL but her supervised visits with mother and own notes contradicted what she submitted to GAL and judge."*

> *"She told me dss had custody and I would do what they told me or my life would become very hard. I wanted to go home. I told them the place I was at wouldn't even let me eat. They made me go back anyway. She is a supervisor there but wouldn't listen or report the abuse of the home I was in"*

> *"Tried to illegally force me to kick my husband out which under north Carolina state law you are not allowed to do without a judge. I told her she needed to take it in front of a judge and she refused and threatened to take my kids. Also tried making my disabled husband work"*

Create Complaint Packet: https://my.standwithmeg.com/reports/actors/nc-andrea-starkey/complaint-packet
Family-reported pattern context only. Each person must file only their own truthful, first-hand complaint using their own facts, dates, evidence, orders, transcripts, and documents.

April Harris Britt

PSYCHOLOGICAL EVALUATOR · WAKE · **3 SUBMISSIONS**

> *"Never even saw my kids and wrote false affidavit against me making up lies. Had LLC with attorney on the case and made money off hundreds of families - Look at her reviews- should NEVER be allowed to work with any families as she should have her license revoked !!! Never even saw my children and wrote affidavit against me in relation to them"*

> *"Lied about everything told to her by us as kids and twisted in court"*

Create Complaint Packet: https://my.standwithmeg.com/reports/actors/nc-april-harris-britt/complaint-packet
Family-reported pattern context only. Each person must file only their own truthful, first-hand complaint using their own facts, dates, evidence, orders, transcripts, and documents.

01 NAMED COURT ACTORS, CONTINUED

Audrey Faith Bell

CPS WORKER · BEAUFORT · **3 SUBMISSIONS**

> *"She failed to protect my son. When he was being held in a facility for 8 months being abused she petitioned the facility for him to remain there longer. She placed him in unsafe environment after the other. When my son went missing she threatened my 15 year old daughter with aiding and abetting. She has been extremely inappropriate with my children. Has told my daughter that I have refused to cooperate with them at all. Made it seem to her like paperwork was the only thing standing in the way of her coming home. Placed my daughter with a pedophile. Recommended my 8 year old daughter be placed with our abuser. Has lied relentlessly in court reports, affidavits, and correspondence to other agencies. I could go on and on about everything she has done. In my opinion, she is a danger to children and I believe she may be a psychopath."*

> *"Was biased and refused to come off my case. Her dad is sitting in jail on dui charges and stealing vehicles. Her mom tried to destroy my business. She refused to let us see our lids and then hid behind a glass windows while she laughed and called the cops"*

> *"Keeping us form commitcateing Ingores any emails as well as refuses us to communicate with him"* BEAUFORT COUNTY

Create Complaint Packet: https://my.standwithmeg.com/reports/actors/nc-audrey-faith-bell/complaint-packet
Family-reported pattern context only. Each person must file only their own truthful, first-hand complaint using their own facts, dates, evidence, orders, transcripts, and documents.

01 NAMED COURT ACTORS, CONTINUED

Elizabeth Heath

JUDGE · LENOIR · **3 SUBMISSIONS**

> *"On multiple occasions she ignored evidence that the social workers on my case had falsified information against me. She made judgements solely based on her personal opinion of me . She signed an order to have two of my children removed from my moms care and placed in foster homes when my daughter fell off the trampoline and broke her wrist. She claimed it was improper supervision. The next morning cps and police came to my home with a non secured custody order for my 6month old baby girl. The petition was 4 paragraphs long. In court my lawyer was able to completely disprove everything on the petition with pictures, paperwork, questioning the case workers on stand. The judge still ruled against me getting my baby back and she was placed into the same foster as my other two kids. Ignored evidence,. Made judgements based on her opinion and personal vendettas rather than from law and general statutes She did not go by the laws and was unfair and she made her judgments and her decision based on her own opinions instead of evidence in the case and instead of going by statutes and laws. She ordered me to 30 days in jail because I left a detox center early by 1 day,. I was 8 months pregnant and ended up having my daughter while still incarcerated."*

> *"Silently retaliate against misusing her authority, bias abusive court proceedings Asisted in the kidnapping of my minor child. Ignored evidence, collusion. Enabling child abuse, domestic violence an parental alienating."* LENIOR COUNTY KINSTON NC

> *"She refused to listen to any evidence from our side. She strictly went by the court report from DSS in the Guardian at Leitem."* LENOIR DSS COURT

Create Complaint Packet: https://my.standwithmeg.com/reports/actors/nc-elizabeth-heath/complaint-packet
Family-reported pattern context only. Each person must file only their own truthful, first-hand complaint using their own facts, dates, evidence, orders, transcripts, and documents.

01 NAMED COURT ACTORS, CONTINUED

George L. Jenkins

ATTORNEY / GAL / CHILD REPRESENTATIVE · LENOIR · **3 SUBMISSIONS**

> *"Supported continued separation from my child while failing to address evidence, due process concerns, and reunification efforts."*

> *"Overing cor dss mistakes, lying under oath, using legal language to trick, demoralize and try to force adoption of kids"*

> *"Opposed reunification efforts and supported decisions that limited visitation and family placement options."*

Create Complaint Packet: https://my.standwithmeg.com/reports/actors/nc-george-l-jenkins/complaint-packet
Family-reported pattern context only. Each person must file only their own truthful, first-hand complaint using their own facts, dates, evidence, orders, transcripts, and documents.

Jennifer Hyler

GAL / CHILD REPRESENTATIVE · LENOIR · **3 SUBMISSIONS**

> *"She lied to me several times concerning my kids and how they were adjusting in their foster home. She moved my children to a different foster home without informing me. She has refused to speak to me for 6 months or longer now. She has made false statements on my character in court multiple times based on opinions. She never went to see my kids in person at their foster home or school/daycare. Always video chat so she has never actually seen their environment"*

> *"She literally never visited or saw the children except on a FaceTime video, and only went by what the caregiver was telling them and wrote her reports according to what the caregivers would say. Meanwhile, my granddaughters were being physically and sexually abused and Foster Care."*
> LENOIR COUNT GAL

> *"Saying I cannot get my kids back"*

Create Complaint Packet: https://my.standwithmeg.com/reports/actors/nc-jennifer-hyler/complaint-packet
Family-reported pattern context only. Each person must file only their own truthful, first-hand complaint using their own facts, dates, evidence, orders, transcripts, and documents.

01 NAMED COURT ACTORS, CONTINUED

Jimmy Love Jr.

JUDGE · FAMILY COURT · **3 SUBMISSIONS**

> *"Forced me into an equitable distribution trial without an attorney, denied my request to submit evidence of separate property and cost me tens of thousands of dollars. He also refused to hear a return hearing on an ex parte order because he wasn't the "assigned" judge in our case."*

> *"He heard her case and his son as a parental coordinator when I had evidence showing medical neglect, and this was not the first time that we had medical neglect. He was also the judge that saw a Debenham."* JOHNSTON

> *"Issued rulings that maintained supervised visitation and prolonged my separation from my children. Spoke with other party before I was allowed into the court room. Gave my children to our abuser."*

Create Complaint Packet: https://my.standwithmeg.com/reports/actors/nc-jimmy-love-jr/complaint-packet
Family-reported pattern context only. Each person must file only their own truthful, first-hand complaint using their own facts, dates, evidence, orders, transcripts, and documents.

Jonathan Jones

JUDGE · BEAUFORT COUNTY · **3 SUBMISSIONS**

> *"This man came in on the tail end of my case as a new judge appointed. I truly do not think he knew or understood what he was up against. He had no reason at that time to disbelieve the dss or gal attorney. He did sign orders that were unconstitutional. He did not verify facts nor speak with parents or allow them to speak on the record or verify the order in court. Six months later in 50 b custody court he undid everything that was put in that original order giving full n sole custody of two of our children back to my husband, their father, after a full trial and him understanding much was hidden and kept from the record in dss court and the kids had in fact been placed with their abuser. This should buy him grace is my book. At great risk to himself and his career here he made it right."*

> *"Put me in jail for 30 days over birth certificate issue that was never mentioned in any petitions or orders. Was also a lawyer representing another in a case against me."* BEAUFORT COUNTY

> *"He allowed "witnesses" to lie on the stand. Denied me ADA access, the list goes on and on."*

Create Complaint Packet: https://my.standwithmeg.com/reports/actors/nc-jonathan-jones/complaint-packet
Family-reported pattern context only. Each person must file only their own truthful, first-hand complaint using their own facts, dates, evidence, orders, transcripts, and documents.

01 NAMED COURT ACTORS, CONTINUED

Jonathan Rex Marvel

JUDGE · CHARLOTTE-MECKLENBURG · **3 SUBMISSIONS**

> *"Denied reviewing the current hundreds of contempts against my ex and called my charges "tit for tat" despite me having a lifetime DVRO!"*

> *"denied my due process, acted illegally, and shamed me"*

Create Complaint Packet: https://my.standwithmeg.com/reports/actors/nc-jonathan-rex-marvel/complaint-packet
Family-reported pattern context only. Each person must file only their own truthful, first-hand complaint using their own facts, dates, evidence, orders, transcripts, and documents.

Keith B. Mason

JUDGE · BEAUFORT COUNTY · **3 SUBMISSIONS**

> *"He was the first judge and continued the 7-10 day hearing without my parents consent and refused to let them or myself or siblings speak. He continued the next hearing as well. At neither hearing he would accept none of my mother's proof. He also did not require or ask DSS to show any proof to keep the nonsecured custody."*

> *"Refused and continued a 7-10 hearing which is not allowed by law. When we made it known he did this and we wrote a letter directly to him he refused to hear anything else with our case or have contact with us at all. I did also name him in a TikTok."*

> *"Allowed my children to be removed from my grandmother over nonsense and yelled at her when she was on the stand (she's almost 80)."*

Create Complaint Packet: https://my.standwithmeg.com/reports/actors/nc-keith-b-mason/complaint-packet
Family-reported pattern context only. Each person must file only their own truthful, first-hand complaint using their own facts, dates, evidence, orders, transcripts, and documents.

01 NAMED COURT ACTORS, CONTINUED

Mario M. White

JUDGE · SAMPSON COUNTY · **3 SUBMISSIONS**

> *"Entered chamber with my attorney on 7/30/25 after I told my attorney that I was going to submit a flash drive into evidence to press charges on caseworker Karissa Henasey for committing pergery on the witness stand. After they came out of the chambers, a mistrial was called to protect the caseworker, and the next day a warrant was taken out for false charges against me. I believe this was planned so that my evidence would have been confiscated, in an attempt to save attorneys and caseworkers from criminal charges."*

> *"He never gave us an option to answer to anything, gave unsupervised visitation to the oldest, he already had crimes against nature charges, but since he wasn't convicted, it was not even considered. 1 yr later he's arrested an charged some horrific charges of the same nature with his other daughter. They literally handed her up on a silver platter to this animal, but we don't have any contact with the middle girl, an very very limited with the other 2"*

> *"Unfair he gives you no voice listens to DSS lawyer & that's it"*

Create Complaint Packet: https://my.standwithmeg.com/reports/actors/nc-mario-m-white/complaint-packet
Family-reported pattern context only. Each person must file only their own truthful, first-hand complaint using their own facts, dates, evidence, orders, transcripts, and documents.

Monica Moore

CPS WORKER · HARNETT · **4 SUBMISSIONS**

> *"My daughter disclosed to her and GAL of SA by her dad. They lied about it in court reports and never did what was mandated by NC 7b laws which is to contact law enforcement and have a CME within 24 hours. Not long after the Oct 8, 2021 hearing she quit HCDSS and went to Sampson /county DSS in NC"*

> *"Added her, because I saw her name on a nearby county complaint and know it's common for caseworkers to go to other neighboring counties. Currently she is on my case in Sampson, but I haven't dealt with her too much yet Not dealt with her too much yet."* SAMPSON

> *"She plays a good role pretends she cares and is going help you but does nothing"*

Create Complaint Packet: https://my.standwithmeg.com/reports/actors/nc-monica-moore/complaint-packet
Family-reported pattern context only. Each person must file only their own truthful, first-hand complaint using their own facts, dates, evidence, orders, transcripts, and documents.

Public threshold rule: Names are grouped conservatively by normalized spelling, role, and location. Common titles, punctuation, casing, and middle initials collapse together. Close misspellings are not auto-merged without admin review. Only family-direct submissions count toward the public threshold.

THE HEADLINE NUMBERS

NORTH CAROLINA AT A GLANCE.

Across 236 North Carolina families reporting through the Family Rights Registry, the patterns are consistent: long durations in court, serious financial loss, and a disproportionate number of parents going unrepresented because they ran out of money fighting.

CHILDREN IMPACTED
431
235 of 236 families reported child counts

MEDIAN FAMILY BURDEN
$140,000
median across 77 families reporting 3+ categories

MEDIAN MONTHS LOST
18
of parenting time

WENT PRO SE
48.7%
115 of 236 who answered; 80 of 236 ran out of money

SUBMISSIONS	AVG CHILDREN / FAMILY	FAMILIES REPORTING CHILDREN	COUNTIES REPRESENTED
236	1.8	235 of 236	67

WHY THIS REPORT EXISTS.

On January 29, 2024, I lost custody of all five of my children.

- NO TRIAL.
- NO QUESTIONING.
- NO SUBSTANTIATED ABUSE.

It took only a signature on an ex parte emergency order to erase a mother. I refused to disappear. I fought back, and built the Family Rights Registry so North Carolina families — and families across every represented location — would stop being invisible to the data. This report is their record.

— MEG · STANDWITHMEG.COM

03 THE COST OF NORTH CAROLINA FAMILY COURT

Legal fees are the largest reported expense, but they are not the only one. Lost wages, evaluation costs, and reunification services compound the financial loss — pushing most families toward pro se representation once their savings run out.

EXPENSE CATEGORY	RESPONSES	MEDIAN	MEAN	TOTAL REPORTED
Attorney Fees	135	$13,000	$72,870	$9,837,414
Lost Wages	98	$11,000	$84,666	$8,297,301
Other Court Fees	56	$2,250	$16,452	$921,325
Therapy / Evaluations	81	$2,500	$6,878	$557,130
Reunification Services	45	$500	$2,436	$109,640
GAL Fees	35	$0	$3,883	$135,920
Asset Loss [1]	82	$69,500	—	—
Median Family Burden (77 families reporting 3+ categories)	—	**$140,000**	—	—

Median vs. mean: Median is the middle reported amount, so it better reflects the typical reporting family when a few very large expenses appear. Mean is the average across reporting families and can be pulled higher by outliers. **Median Family Burden** is the median of total reported expenses across families who reported costs in 3 or more expense categories with a combined total of at least $1,000 — a true median of real family totals, restricted to families who filled out enough of the financial section to characterize their case and excluding obvious data-entry artifacts.

1. On asset loss: One respondent reported an extreme outlier that skews the mean beyond usefulness. We report the median ($69,500) and suppress the mean and total, pending data-quality review. Lost Wages also contains wide variance; median is the honest headline.

LOST PARENTING TIME · MONTHS



04 WHO IS REPORTING · NORTH CAROLINA

Most families documenting in North Carolina are currently active in, or recently closed out of, long-running cases. Nearly half have lost all contact with their children. Percentages below use only families who answered that specific topic.

CASE STATUS · SYSTEM AFFECTED

CASE STATUS

Active case: stuck or delayed	117	50%
Case closed: within last 2 years	39	17%
Not provided	25	11%
Not in court but still affected	18	8%
Active case: progress being made	18	8%

SYSTEM AFFECTED

Both Family Court and CPS	103	44%
Family Court Only	86	36%
CPS Only	29	12%
Unknown	18	8%

DURATION · CUSTODY OUTCOMES

TIME IN SYSTEM

1 – 3 years	70	30%
5 – 10 years	43	18%
3 – 5 years	38	16%
6 months – 1 year	27	12%
Over 10 years	26	11%

CUSTODY STATUS

No Contact / Total Loss of Access	58	25%
Visitation Only	57	24%
50/50 Joint	49	21%
Children in Foster Care	31	13%
Full Custody	22	9%

GEOGRAPHY · ALLEGATIONS REPORTED

TOP COUNTIES

Wake	17	8%
Buncombe	12	6%
Lenoir	12	6%
Johnston	12	6%
Mecklenburg	12	6%
Beaufort	10	5%

TOP ALLEGATIONS REPORTED

Family Court False Accusations (Domestic Violence/Abuse/Alienation)	71	30%
False Accusations CPS (Non-Medical) (Vengeful ex-partner, malicious report)	49	21%
High Conflict Divorce	39	17%
Other	28	12%
Other: (Short answer)	9	4%

05 PARENT VOICES — NORTH CAROLINA

Selected voice excerpts appear here for readability. Every approved, shareable North Carolina comment is printed in full in the appendix that follows.

> *Biased and fraud investigation from CPS Trumanda Raines has ruined me as a father to my kids from almost 8yrs.*
>
> — MICHAEL

ON THE REPORTED ALLEGATIONS

My ex made false allegations which led (With the recommendation and advice give by CPS) to the no contact ex parte order of my child without any hearing or trial be held. Also, Corruption and Harrasement within the county caused constitutional laws to be broken.

— NORTH CAROLINA PARENT · AARON

MORE VOICES FROM NORTH CAROLINA

Decades of lost time, legal abuse, financial abuse, and emotional abuse to those that were the victims of domestic violence. Silence is death do not stop fighting for your children no matter the threats or the attacks because God will help you stand for justice.

— AMY

The Family Court and CPS system unlawfully and viciously destroyed my children and myself through fraud, lies, and incentives for profit. Family court literally destroyed everything that mattered to me and is still participating with state sponsored abuse.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

They destroyed my family abused my children and sold them for bonuses and profit from me and adopted them out to strangers

— AIMEE

I can not put a dollar amount on what has been done. I'm currently fighting to keep my home, and I am not able to find a job that I'm qualified for due to false charges that the attorneys and judge's refuse to dismiss due to lack of evidence. Due to the false charge it is more [...]

— SARAH

05 PARENT VOICES, CONTINUED

> *The system has systematically torn apart our loving family under the guise of 'best interests of the children,' while the court and DSS—driven by profit, not justice—have violated our constitutional rights, ignored documented corruption and perjury, and now illegally demand that [...]*
>
> — JENNETTE

The Buncombe Co family law system and schools failed to protect me from an abuser that kidnapped my daughter from me. I suffer greatly emotionally on a daily basis dealing with the pain of losing my daughter and the false accusations. I suffer from bouts of intense depression [...]

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Cumberland County has severely traumatized myself and my children my allowing this abuse to continue for over two years. They have caused me to develop severe CPTSD.

— APRIL

The corrupt family court system has enabled the mother of my children to keep my children away from me for the last 6 years and has caused unimaginable pain for them and myself and has stolen years that we will never get back!

— GAVIN

The system has completely tore my family apart. Leaving my kids in a home full of chaos and abuse.We are beyond traumatized.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Completely ignores other possible family members to place the children so they can keep them in custody. Violation of Rights Under Color of Law

— DERREKA

They took my life away. My husband and mother both committed suicide over the lose. I morn my children everyday and they are still alive

— ANGEL

CPS allows physical and verbal abuse on mothers along with selling my children through child trafficking. That is not child safety, that is abuse on our children and mothers.

— ALLISON

DSS with the help of my immigrant ex-wife not able to speak english the case worker fabricated false statements to build a case against me destroying our family. A corrupt evil DSS supervisor in charge said to me you did something wrong. DSS/JUDGE/GAL threaten brainwashed [...]

— FEDERICO

05 PARENT VOICES, CONTINUED

> *It has destroyed my kids. Plan and simple while leaving me broke from just trying to be a dad.*
>
> — JP

Ripped my world away broke my heart because I'm seeing now my children are suffering and being neglected from their own father.

— AMANDA

My kids have already lost one parent. Now cps is helping them lose another. This is inhumane

— LEAH

They destroyed the life my children and I had. I now have no life with my children.

— STEPHANIE

The court has destroyed my family and my children childhood and mental well being.

— CATHY

Lenoir county DSS came into our lives with the notion that they were there to help us rebuild after a brutal and traumatic experience. Instead,they came in and completely ripped my family apart . Slandered my name and character. Caused my kids emotional, mental, and even [...]

— SYDNI

Judge was horrible- would not listen, finalized order that put me out of house and home. And my kids best interest not considered in the slightest.

— JENNIFER

Ripped us into shreds, torn us.. broken us.. hurt us so badly. Traumatized my children to where they NEEDED therapy & things they NEVER needed PRIOR. Yet they use that as reason to KEEP THEM. Altered my records & my husband's, demanding things from our jobs which caused us to be [...]

— BRITTANY

Taken my children's mother away with judges that won't make decisions and forensic interviews that are never read. I feel like nobody cares but me.

— VALERIE

05 PARENT VOICES, CONTINUED

> *This system has destroyed the soul of a child, her father's grief cannot be put into words, our children have missed out on months, if not years of having their own parents mentally healthy due to the stress and trauma, they have endured trauma of their own due to living with a [...]*
>
> — ERIN

Abused my child, incarcerated me twice, made me pay opposing counsel fees, denied me a court appointed attorney for Contempt, took my child away, retaliated.

— JACQUELYN

I faced the unimaginable when trying to protect my children from harm. Over 900 days of separation after 5 years and 100 court hearings.

— SAPPHIRE

They took my kids for false report and now I'm gonna go to court Tuesday the 16 and I was told I was gonna get unsupervised visit but not they asking for me to have supervised visit

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

They lost my son, he has been missing since September 23, 2025. They have consistently tried to cover up the unconstitutional seizure of my children. They scrubbed reports and gave my 8 year old daughter to our abuser and placed my 15 year old daughter with a pedophile.

— JESSICA

Brunswick NC is corrupt county And they stole my children and made up Lies about my family with no proof of Anything happens to my children it was all false allegations and when I went to the group test and I passed it they said I had to see my children And then I go to see my [...]

— TAMMY

Family court has enabled and allowed my abuser to continue his abuse and destroy the life of my children and I. I am the only one fighting for the rights of my children while they suffer, psychologically, emotionally and behaviorally. It is the most traumatic experience I have [...]

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

This system has allowed financial abuse and intimidation that put me in crippling debt without any acknowledgement or repercussions by the Judge of my ex's purposeful stunts to increase my legal bills.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

The North Carolina Family Court system, particular those actors in Union County, has consistently violated rights and broken the law, to the point of Erin Hucks, Stephen Higdon, and Wendy Maynard destroying evidence, and various actors enforcing jail time and false protective [...]

— WARREN

05 PARENT VOICES, CONTINUED

> *Due to the emergency case being drug out for entirely too long, there has been lost time with the child. The system has proved to be incredible corrupt with this judge and attorney.*
>
> — ANONYMOUS PARENT

My boys that I raised alone were instantly ripped from their mother and have been told horrible untrue things about me to try and turn them against me. After domestic violence testimony and tons of evidence the judge still took my babies.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Family court was a nightmare that felt as though it would never end. It nearly killed me. It tore our family apart and left my daughters (both) destroyed with PTSD on top of the abuse their father did to them- then family court punished them even further.

— JENNIFER

Compete and utter destruction and trauma along with PTSD. Allowing a Narcissist to almost destroy my kids by trying to emotionally, financially and physically ruin me.

— JENNIFER

The system has caused irreversible trauma and stress. There have been delays on plans for our family and home renovations.

— STEVEN

They have destroyed our family! Gave my boys to a monster who is in jail awaiting trial for unaliving my oldest son n now my 2 other boys are back in state custody with no contact. I was always supposed to be kept in thier lives . This was a reunification case not adoption !

— FELICIA

has gave him temp custody he has no car no job etc and i moved back judge won't grant a ex parte even thou he could be in another state kids haven't talked me in 3 n half weeks . i been back since dec 12 still haven't seen them. oh and the 6yr old supposed have started school.

— TAYLOR

I lost everything. My marriage, my children, my identity, my family, my peace, my health. My reputation. My belongings and home. I was diagnosed with permanent hip injury, PTSD, Adjustment Disorder from all that.

— SARAH

It has taken our babies an destroyed our lives, an made 2 little girls suffer unimaginable horrors, with no intentions of re-uniting

— KATRINA

153 North Carolina parents submitted approved, shareable comments. 42 selected excerpts appear here; the full comments begin on the next page.

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS — NORTH CAROLINA

The comments below are the full approved, publicly shareable survey comments from North Carolina families. Data-only and do-not-share submissions are excluded from this public appendix.

> Biased and fraud investigation from CPS Trumanda Raines has ruined me as a father to my kids from almost 8yrs.
>
> — MICHAEL

> Decades of lost time, legal abuse, financial abuse, and emotional abuse to those that were the victims of domestic violence. Silence is death do not stop fighting for your children no matter the threats or the attacks because God will help you stand for justice.
>
> — AMY

> The Family Court and CPS system unlawfully and viciously destroyed my children and myself through fraud, lies, and incentives for profit. Family court literally destroyed everything that mattered to me and is still participating with state sponsored abuse.
>
> — ANONYMOUS PARENT

> They destroyed my family abused my children and sold them for bonuses and profit from me and adopted them out to strangers
>
> — AIMEE

> My ex made false allegations which led (With the recommendation and advice give by CPS) to the no contact ex parte order of my child without any hearing or trial be held. Also, Corruption and Harrasement within the county caused constitutional laws to be broken.
>
> — AARON

> I can not put a dollar amount on what has been done. I'm currently fighting to keep my home, and I am not able to find a job that I'm qualified for due to false charges that the attorneys and judge's refuse to dismiss due to lack of evidence. Due to the false charge it is more difficult to support my children while they're in custody, but I believe that this was the plan.
>
> — SARAH

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

The system has systematically torn apart our loving family under the guise of 'best interests of the children,' while the court and DSS —driven by profit, not justice—have violated our constitutional rights, ignored documented corruption and perjury, and now illegally demand that I abandon my own home for six months to a year as a condition for reunification, forcing us to choose between our rights and our children! UNITED WE STAND AND UNITED WE FIGHT!

— JENNETTE

The Buncombe Co family law system and schools failed to protect me from an abuser that kidnapped my daughter from me. I suffer greatly emotionally on a daily basis dealing with the pain of losing my daughter and the false accusations. I suffer from bouts of intense depression, anxiety, and PTSD. The supposed 'helpers' were all happy to take my money in the thousands, until I went bankrupt while lying to me saying they could help. In reality the system drew a further wedge between my daughter and I, resulting in no contact. I am left feeling like a victim of abuse with no assistance and zero support. I have been severely traumatized, humiliated, embarrassed, and financially ruined. I will probably never see my daughter again. It is the worst pain you could ever feel or imagine. The family court system in Buncombe Co is atrociously slow and fails to protect families and children. The Buncombe Co school system allowed my ex and daughter to violate a court order.Therapists and mediators also failed to address anything pertainent that actually could've helped my case. Everyone completely abanded me and neglected to listen to me and my concerns. Now my two daughters are seperated and will never know each other or have a bond. Ultimately it is the children who suffer the most, because adults fail at their jobs and fail at being decent human beings.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Cumberland County has severely traumatized myself and my children my allowing this abuse to continue for over two years. They have caused me to develop severe CPTSD.

— APRIL

The corrupt family court system has enabled the mother of my children to keep my children away from me for the last 6 years and has caused unimaginable pain for them and myself and has stolen years that we will never get back!

— GAVIN

The system has completely tore my family apart. Leaving my kids in a home full of chaos and abuse.We are beyond traumatized.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

Completely ignores other possible family members to place the children so they can keep them in custody. Violation of Rights Under Color of Law

— DERREKA

They took my life away. My husband and mother both committed suicide over the lose. I morn my children everyday and they are still alive

— ANGEL

CPS allows physical and verbal abuse on mothers along with selling my children through child trafficking. That is not child safety, that is abuse on our children and mothers.

— ALLISON

DSS with the help of my immigrant ex-wife not able to speak english the case worker fabricated false statements to build a case against me destroying our family. A corrupt evil DSS supervisor in charge said to me you did something wrong. DSS/JUDGE/GAL threaten brainwashed tortured my wife and child putting the baby child into foster care because my wife wanted to correct the written allegation she had wrote and copy from DSS in english. Note: My wife could not read, speak or write in english. Total family destruction not repairable..

— FEDERICO

It has destroyed my kids. Plan and simple while leaving me broke from just trying to be a dad.

— JP

Ripped my world away broke my heart because I'm seeing now my children are suffering and being neglected from their own father.

— AMANDA

My kids have already lost one parent. Now cps is helping them lose another. This is inhumane

— LEAH

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

They destroyed the life my children and I had. I now have no life with my children.

— STEPHANIE

The court has destroyed my family and my children childhood and mental well being.

— CATHY

Lenoir county DSS came into our lives with the notion that they were there to help us rebuild after a brutal and traumatic experience. Instead,they came in and completely ripped my family apart . Slandered my name and character. Caused my kids emotional, mental, and even physical trauma throughout this case . And they have done this unlawfully, illegally, and maliciously.

— SYDNI

Judge was horrible- would not listen, finalized order that put me out of house and home. And my kids best interest not considered in the slightest.

— JENNIFER

Ripped us into shreds, torn us.. broken us.. hurt us so badly. Traumatized my children to where they NEEDED therapy & things they NEVER needed PRIOR. Yet they use that as reason to KEEP THEM. Altered my records & my husband's, demanding things from our jobs which caused us to be let off. Adding charges to records we don't have. Slandering our names badly. It's ruined our life's completely. My kids didn't even get a chance at life..

— BRITTANY

Taken my children’s mother away with judges that won’t make decisions and forensic interviews that are never read. I feel like nobody cares but me.

— VALERIE

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

This system has destroyed the soul of a child, her father's grief cannot be put into words, our children have missed out on months, if not years of having their own parents mentally healthy due to the stress and trauma, they have endured trauma of their own due to living with a sibling with undiagnosed reactive attachment from all she has experienced, we have all lost opportunities that would have been life changing, & we went without so much, from a dependable car, let alone a second car, or a nicer place to live due to the amount of money we have to delegate to this. Presently we are in a financial hole due to the mental health needs resulting in residential stays that only we are paying for, plus now having to hire an attorney again.

— ERIN

Abused my child, incarcerated me twice, made me pay opposing counsel fees, denied me a court appointed attorney for Contempt, took my child away, retaliated.

— JACQUELYN

I faced the unimaginable when trying to protect my children from harm. Over 900 days of separation after 5 years and 100 court hearings.

— SAPPHIRE

They took my kids for false report and now I'm gonna go to court Tuesday the 16 and I was told I was gonna get unsupervised visit but not they asking for me to have supervised visit

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

They lost my son, he has been missing since September 23, 2025. They have consistently tried to cover up the unconstitutional seizure of my children. They scrubbed reports and gave my 8 year old daughter to our abuser and placed my 15 year old daughter with a pedophile.

— JESSICA

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

Brunswick NC is corrupt county And they stole my children and made up Lies about my family with no proof of Anything happens to my children it was all false allegations and when I went to the group test and I passed it they said I had to see my children And then I go to see my children here come to deputy sheriff's I went to prison for something I didn't do I took a plea for something I didn't do it I was innocent all because I didn't know how to do and I didn't believe that you would get locked up for something you didn't do The caseworkers were liars They told my children we died in a car accident and I was not able to see much of them or have it from years I had to make a breakdown Mentally I was unable to deal with it and I had to start seeing a therapist

— TAMMY

Family court has enabled and allowed my abuser to continue his abuse and destroy the life of my children and I. I am the only one fighting for the rights of my children while they suffer, psychologically, emotionally and behaviorally. It is the most traumatic experience I have ever been put through, more so, than losing both parents to cancer.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

This system has allowed financial abuse and intimidation that put me in crippling debt without any acknowledgement or repercussions by the Judge of my ex's purposeful stunts to increase my legal bills.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

The North Carolina Family Court system, particular those actors in Union County, has consistently violated rights and broken the law, to the point of Erin Hucks, Stephen Higdon, and Wendy Maynard destroying evidence, and various actors enforcing jail time and false protective orders.

— WARREN

Due to the emergency case being drug out for entirely too long, there has been lost time with the child. The system has proved to be incredible corrupt with this judge and attorney.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

My boys that I raised alone were instantly ripped from their mother and have been told horrible untrue things about me to try and turn them against me. After domestic violence testimony and tons of evidence the judge still took my babies.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Family court was a nightmare that felt as though it would never end. It nearly killed me. It tore our family apart and left my daughters (both) destroyed with PTSD on top of the abuse their father did to them- then family court punished them even further.

— JENNIFER

Compete and utter destruction and trauma along with PTSD. Allowing a Narcissist to almost destroy my kids by trying to emotionally, financially and physically ruin me.

— JENNIFER

The system has caused irreversible trauma and stress. There have been delays on plans for our family and home renovations.

— STEVEN

They have destroyed our family! Gave my boys to a monster who is in jail awaiting trial for unaliving my oldest son n now my 2 other boys are back in state custody with no contact. I was always supposed to be kept in thier lives . This was a reunification case not adoption !

— FELICIA

has gave him temp custody he has no car no job etc and i moved back judge won't grant a ex parte even thou he could be in another state kids haven't talked me in 3 n half weeks . i been back since dec 12 still haven't seen them. oh and the 6yr old supposed have started school.

— TAYLOR

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

I lost everything. My marriage, my children, my identity, my family, my peace, my health. My reputation. My belongings and home. I was diagnosed with permanent hip injury, PTSD, Adjustment Disorder from all that.

— SARAH

It has taken our babies an destroyed our lives, an made 2 little girls suffer unimaginable horrors, with no intentions of re-uniting

— KATRINA

Stole my life and ruined my children

— DONNELLA

The broken system has broken my family and destroyed my childrens emotional well being that years of therapy won't ever truly heal all because I just wanted help, I wanted dad held accountable for DV.

— SHANNON

Taken my kids from a happy, healthy home. With a regular schedule. To a neglectful, abusive environment. Taken my health due to loss of livelihood. Forced us to endure abuse.

— BROOKE

I have personally seen Holly do everything she can to advocate for herself and her children, only to feel silenced and treated unfairly. I have seen the damage caused by the system and how much the separation from her girls have hurt her in many ways.

— STACEY

My family was torn apart and all the trama and lies and hurt myself and kids have had to endure is so wrong

— COURTNEY

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

CPS took advantage of my depression and used it as a tool for attempted murder! Completely annihilated my family.

— NICOLE

No due process from a cheating spouse, quick Absolute-Divorce within months (lied about timeframe). Created hostile environment after divorce and used false allegations and “mean words” to secure DVPO; limiting access to son. Alienation has been used to make some hate his father with “he’s not safe”

— SHAUN

Destroyed my health, safety, peace of mind and I’ve lost job after job, currently facing homelessness due to constant court hearings.

— TAMEKA

Ripped it apart. Took a part of me away and ill never be the same until i get them back

— ERICA

Avery county department of social services have destroyed my entire life for their financial gain. They never had our families best interest and defnately not my children's

— CARRIE

Family Court and Cps knowingly placed my child in the arms of a violent abuser who then committed crimes against her so heinous he's in prison for a decade. Only a fraction of time compared to the life long psychological trauma that she will have to endure. They robbed me of my baby because I refused to stop trying to protect her.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

The rulings profoundly altered my children’s lives, leaving our family feeling unheard, unprotected, and forever changed.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

My children were wrongly taken from me.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

They have robbed me and my children of precious time we will never get back

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

The system has terrorized and tormented me psychologically and emotionally for over 10 years. It has taken my parental rights, my human rights, my civil rights, and my constitutional rights. I have no rights to my children other than “visitation”, supervised at one point.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Loss of time with child. Loss of job traumatizing to child and family

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Franklin county has destroyed my family and my marriage, they are making me choose between my kids and my husband and trying to substantiate over something that never happened and my kids say never happened.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

As a stay at home mom who gave everything I have been destroyed to learn that the system is not designed to protect women from abuse. The person with the most money wins and everyone is looking for a payday from you. I would have been better off if my ex had cheated on me.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

In my high conflict custody/support case, the Judge admitted evidence of wrongdoing then sanctioned me for showing crimes/misconduct of opposing counsel because I was harassing him. Opposing counsel started dating the Defendant, got suspended for 2yrs and has been on felony bail for 3 years with 30+ criminal records. I drained my entire life savings, lost a 4M business, came close to losing my freedom and my relationship with my kids has suffered greatly. The Bar says 'even if true, wouldn't violate their rules' the Attorney General says talk to the bar, local police defer to the bar, District Attorneys and every other attorney refuses to sue another attorney.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Every government board im there to speak for justice. I been put in jail, charged and retailiated against for telling this veterans story

— JERRY

This system re-traumatized myself and my children in an unnecessarily cruel manner that one would never anticipate experiencing in a democratic, law-abiding society.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

all the judges and lawyers work together in johnston county,

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

This system took my children, our time, our milestones, and our peace, while forcing me to fight to prove the love and bond that never should have been questioned. I want people to know that family separation is not just a court case, it is lifelong harm to children and parents.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

This has cost my parents their retirement savings. They will now have to work until they die because the judge did not handle it in a reasonable or even remotely timely manner. It has cost my sister and her children a lot of trauma and sadness over the last year because the judge showed favoritism. It is absolutely mind boggling that the case when the way it did. Unheard of.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

> Mrs peacock of peacock family practice is the main bad actor in this whole affair. Because of her I have lost many a nights sleep.
>
> — CLAUS

> Ruined the foundation of a loving Mom and her children's safety in this world. Total loss of trust in an judicial system.
>
> — ANONYMOUS PARENT

> It has torn my family apart. My children are the ones completely suffering and no one is helping them.
>
> — ANONYMOUS PARENT

> I don’t feel like I can get a fair hearing in this county when the judge that’s been assigned to my case that shown so much bias.
>
> — ANONYMOUS PARENT

> Separated children from the place they were born and loved. Alienated them and made me chose work or visitation. Lost my job. More alienation.
>
> — ANONYMOUS PARENT

> The system is coming to my home and in my life and myself and my children and have completely changed our spirits our personalities and the way we view life. We won't constantly in fear everyday not knowing if we're going to be separated or what we're going to be facing if we're going to be sexually assaulted or stolen from each other. We now live life constantly in fear with a broken hearts and not knowing what the future holds unable to trust anyone or anything.
>
> — SARA

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

It has ripped our family apart and gave my kids to foster families where theybe been molsted and tried to tell me they were doing whats best for my kids...i wanted to make them go thru what they made my kids and i go thru really but wven tho have wronged us so bad im not that kinda person. They robbed us of hope and a futur together.

— EMILY

They stole my children my home tore apart everything I worked for used my past against me as weapon and my emotional vunerlabilty as a weapon and threaten they would get adopted out in the next trial if I did not sign my rights over.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Parental Allination, Fraser accusations, things were said to the child that weren't true,narcissist abuser

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

My son rarely sees some of his siblings. It has absolutely taken away a lot of should be memories.

— CHRISTINE

The system has destroyed our way of life and made life a struggle for us because we are forced to spend time with and have to co-parent with our abuser. He continues to emotionally and verbally abuse our daughters and attempts to do the same to me. Luckily years of counseling has taught me how to ignore his attempts. I have been forced to stay in a state with no family or support system. My health has greatly suffered from all the stress. I have an autoimmune disease that will never go away and will haunt me for the rest of my life because of the way he treated me and our girls. He took something from me that I can never get back despite tons of evidence that the judge refused to look at. I was never given any post separation support despite being a dependent spouse for 12 years so my credit was ruined and I struggled financially for years and am still trying to recover from the financial destruction he has caused me. Our daughters are teenagers now and very angry. They were forced to go from the life they knew to a total opposite change of what they knew literally over night. The stress they went through and are continuing to experience is horrible and so unfair to them.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

They tore my children out of a loving safe home.... This distorted my whole life.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Hell right here on earth every second of every day non stop torture

— JENNIFER

The system openly ignored the fact that my children were being exposed to Marijuana - being used in front of children in an illegal state, unhealthy living conditions, unsafe sleeping arrangements and had a lack of proper hygiene and grooming, to keep the children in a town their "entire lives were spent in" the oldest was 5. The judge simple ignored all evidence due to the fact I was planning to move to a different state were both myself and them would have family support.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Turns out "family court " forgot the family part . Best interest of the child" sounds good, but in practice, it can feel like budgets and procedure matter more than children's actual needs. We lived the gap between the slogan and the reality. Children deserve more than a slogan .

— BECKA

Taken my child through an emergency order riddled with false allegations and indicated she was adaptable for placement families....held her in cps custody over 1 year with still no hearing to date

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

This is not a system to protect children, it is a system of lies and manipulation to obtain funds which ever way they can extort it!

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

The system has stolen time and been completely unjust to my child, my family and myself, and not doing what is best for the minor child's interest.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Our girls not being with us has completely devastated us. All the money spent and continued to be spent could have been used for them and their education. Corrupt Judges and court officials need to be held accountable.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

I understand I made a mistake, but I never abused my kid. I have missed out on so much because he got taken at 3 & 1/2 months & is now 14 months.. he's my first... so I've missed out on actually being his mom

— REBA

The system has torn my family apart

— STACY

Family court did not protect my child or my family. It prolonged conflict, drained our finances, and cost us years of irreplaceable time together.

— NICOLE

They have lied numerous of times they have disrespected me too many times they removed my babies from me because my two year old got killed in the baby sitter care. They have interfered with my work life my personal life going against rules and regulations. They said they were waiting on the autopsy for my baby. They have it now and still no movement or progress. They still letting the babysitter roam around and they got all proof my two year old was with the babysitter they kept my son in a bad place instead of sending him home where he needs to be. They took my newborn from me after they stated someone could move with me until the autopsy came back and they left my newborn in the hospital for 2-3 weeks. The nurses were treating me like crap because of CPS. The detective said she needed to get a specialized doctor after the autopsy came to see exactly what home my baby died and it states my baby was with the babysitter.

— JORDAN

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

The system tried to destroy and break our family simply for money because three of our children have disabilities they could cash in on. That same system tried to silence us l, paint us as liars, when the proof didn't match the story they were telling. WE WILL NEVER STOP TELLING OUR STORY!!! If we help and save just one other family it was not for nothing. We are together. Our family fights together. They chose the wrong ones. All of my children are home because our voices, our proof, MATTERED.

— JUANITA

This system has alienated me from my children and their lives. It has denied my children of their mother and the close relationship we once had. The system doesn't care about "the best interest" of the children, they care about continuing the cycle for profit. Judges are not held accountable for perjuring themselves. They say one thing and do another. This system is a joke.

— ALEXIS

The system put my child in the custody of an abusive grandparent who isolates her from me and other loving people

— MANDY

This system has been weaponized in order to sow separation between my daughter and I. Leaving me in a constant state of anxiety and sadness.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

I have never experienced such heartbreak and distrust in individuals and a system built to protect children. NCDHHS should be appalled at the gross oversight and atrocities being committed.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

They have systematically degraded my relationship with my children, and enabled the parallel parent to alienate me and caused untold damage to the children resulting in mental health issues and prescriptions that are normally reserved for severe mental disorders.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

> This experience has left me carrying a level of grief that is difficult to put into words. I have spent nearly three years mourning children who are still alive, missing moments I can never get back, and living with a pain that follows me from the moment I wake up until I go to sleep. I'm no longer the same woman and my mental health is severely destroyed and struggling to maintain hope. I feel as if I no longer have a purpose in life and I'm not sure how much longer I can continue to hold on.
>
> — ANONYMOUS PARENT

> Scummy people doing scummy things!
>
> — ANONYMOUS PARENT

> This system is not about the best interest of the child, as this child lived in consistant danger for almost 10 years. Keep fighting for those children. The good old boy system is real in Gaston County.
>
> — ANONYMOUS PARENT

> Tore my family apart, I haven't seen my babies since 2017& 2018!
>
> — ANONYMOUS PARENT

> I have missed moments with my baby that I will never get back, and the pain of being separated from my child has affected every part of my life. I want people to know that parents and children should not be torn apart without real evidence, fairness, and due process.
>
> — ANONYMOUS PARENT

> It brought us back together better than ever.
>
> — ANONYMOUS PARENT

> It has stole my natural right as a mother to build bond with child qnd the wmotional stress on the children and the mother.. in the be batudal qorkd what effecta does it have on aby other mother that has its baby taken or hurt...
>
> — ANONYMOUS PARENT

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

I have learned that the truth does not prevail. The only thing that previails is the agenda and that is done at any cost. My children are now alienated from me; essentially they have nothing to do with ne. During the three years DSS kept this case open with no services my son (14) became addicted to drugs, selling drugs, went from A/B honor roll to being on an IEP, both my kids got suspended from school, both became quite the experts at stealing from stores, my son had a sex tape that was leaked. The system anhilated my family!

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

The system is not fair, and I believe he say should not be taken into account without proper documentation. I see a weird perspective on mothers nowadays that can be detrimental to the children and lawyers are very lazy now in this generation..

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Randolph county CPS has tore my family apart has made me sicker than I can even imagine to tell you has put a breaking point between me and my daughter and my husband our family is gone because of them and I can't trust the law or the judicial system that I grew up thinking they knew what they were doing and that they believed in truth

— TERRI

Forced my autistic child to remain in custody of abusive ex because the court don’t care

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

I’ve witnessed a very unfair and concerning amount of corruption in this court room as a witness. I am deeply concerned for the justice system in this county and have lost faith in honorable decision making.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Destroyed our family, testimony should not be believed without evidence to support. Family court should be held accountable and rules changed to what is allowed- not who they believe more, Narcissist protect their image.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

It has caused my children to be scared of the government. Non-trusting of people and scared to develop relationships with good people. Also my son has been abused while in their custody and he is very angry and will cut people out of his life quickly. These were happy, well- adjusted, loving children, going through this has left scars no one can see but I can feel every day.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

They have made me lose so many first milestones with my son I've missed school pictures, yearbooks, first tooth, field day, dances, programs, Christmases. He's missed his brother's graduation.

— CHRISTINE

The Charlotte-Mecklenburg Judiciary has cost me over 6 years of an already horrific, adjudicated system of ABUSE. Irena Zarutska put this county on the map with it's bad behavior and sadly, that women, who lost her life has seemingly crossed over to a better place than this town. This town should be exposed for its injustice. (Is there an email I can provide with all of my story that I sent to ACLU?)

— KRISTEN

I was wrongful accused and DSS has no proof of allegations. My oldest daughter came home. But the youngest is still being alienated from me

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Severe prolonged psychological damage and traumatic mental health physical deterioration. PTSD, depression near death. Tremendous strain and stress near loss of external family. Word's can't describe. Death. Death of hope. Stroke, heart attack, seizures job loss reputation destruction online repetition slander reputation destruction resulting in joblessness and in a few weeks homelessness.

— TRAVIS

Alienated me from constitutional fatherhood and the quiet enjoyment thereof

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

Since my child has been in public schools l, have had multiple cases opened. I have even had multiple cases opened in the same week.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Completely tore apart

— HEATHER

Tried to rip us apart as in they tried to make my husband and I divorce told us that they had someone that wanted to adopt our children. We presume it was my in-laws because they've been trying to get me to sign my son over to them

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Multiple counties conspired together to destroy my home and peace of mind.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Ruined our entire life!!!

— BRITNY

The Charlotte North Carolina Court system is incredibly corrupt. They would rather standby a repeated felon, then help a victim with a lifetime domestic violence restraining order.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

My high conflict ex has accused me of multiple types of abuse and when I agreed to a full custody evaluation ($20,000+), he dismissed the findings - no evidence of abuse against me but evidence of manipulation and lying from him.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

I have been separated from my children for over 5 years wrongfully through a conspiracy between DSS and law enforcement. The judges and DSS purposely drag a case out for as long as possible and are always against reunification even when there is absolutely no evidence to support a lawful separation while knowing the devastating effects it is having on the children.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

This hasn't been the best year or set of seasons for us all. My husband and I have been separated over 11 months. My daughter is also been gone for over 11 months. The constant pressure of promises of Reunification is a constant disappointment and a plethora of other issues or reasons why we cannot reunite due to her mental health. I went through with not just already being a clean addict in a active recovery for 18 months and 23 days and go to Narcotics Anonymous, Co-Dependency Anonymous, Two Triple P Parenting Seminars, Several sessions with A Psychologist for a psychological evaluation. I went to Caldwell County Domestic Violence Abuse Education Zoom Classes, CPS Parenting Program provided for me for ARC Parenting Zoom Classes services, 2 hour visits supervised for the past 11 months and only a few unsupervised sessions with her and myself. Then meeting the Foster Parents halfway which gas is expensive for whatever that's worth and I'm on social security disability income which is not even close to enough to keep everything else in place and on time bill wise but I do my best.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

They stole my nephew.

— SANDRA

Tore my family apart

— KYESHA

As a veteran who served this country honorably, it has been devastating to feel discarded by a system that I believe failed to hear me while I watched years with my children disappear. I believe the other parent hid behind military status and influence while I was left fighting to be recognized as a father, missing milestones and memories I can never get back.

— ROYDRICK

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

This entire debacle of a case has smeared myself and both my parents and every once in awhile siblings as a result of these false allegations. It is affecting my ability to work. To find work. TO be hired as a machinist/ PLC worker where my work experience rests in. It caused me to loose friends and allies along with creating spiritual attacks that have led me to become sort of like a pastor in order to combat those off. I am bullied when I go out in public, and people have mentioned that I should "wear a hat more".

— MIGUEL

Burke county CPS admitted to wrongdoing in my case, yet would never say what exactly. When I started filing motions demanding answers, they transferred my case to Catawba county so they wouldn't have to let me know exactly what wrongdoing they did, although I imagine it's everything in the entire case. The court papers I was first served with says my son is a 16 year old Guatemalan, however, he's a 2 year old Caucasian boy.

— MIRANDA

The family court system has broken my faith in the Anerican Justice system, hurt my mental health, my family's savings is gone letting mine and my childs abuser win absolutely everything. A man that hasn't seen or talked to his child in 2 years and hurt him has full and complete custody a man with 100% disability mostly from severe mental health.

— REBECCA

I have developed an autoimmune disorder. I have lost a ton of friends and hair. I have high blood pressure and trouble sleeping. I have started blood pressure medication and sleeping medicine. I'm only 31.

— TORI

It has affected my mental and emotional state. I feel like I am losing hope and not being treated like a human being. My Son is my reason for everything and now that he is gone I feel like I have nothing left in this world.

— CHELSEA

Former pissed off foster kid

— CHRIS

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

> It has made my children regress in certain developmental milestones. It has tore my family apart. My family havent been able to see my children for awhile now. I've missed so many important milestones for my children because of what DSS has done to me and my family. I just want my children home where they belong. Not for someone else to raise them.
>
> — ANONYMOUS PARENT

> I'm just here to be nosey
>
> — ANONYMOUS PARENT

> I have been discarded from my son's life. I was trying to be a parent, the system chose to side with what a 17 year old wanted, to live with his "easier" parent and ignored my testimony.
>
> — ANONYMOUS PARENT

> The lies that were told and upheld in family court allowed my dad to win because he had all the money, and it cost us as teenagers to be forced to go live with him again after he was abusive to us through our childhood.
>
> — ANONYMOUS PARENT

> They have violated my right to due process (not letting the court-ordered expert testify; when their report didn't align with their narrative). They violated my right to raise my children and be a part of their lives, which is protected under the 14th Amendment of the Constitution. They violated the 7th Amendment and executed involuntary servitude when they made me pay child support with no criminal record, no reason for termination of my time with children, and no benefit in paying. They subjected us all to more DV I talked to my daughter 12 times in 1 year and those were very brief calls, maybe 15 min at most. My son was neglected to the point of ICU admission, continual court hearings to prove things that were already proved because they don't want to ruin dad's military career.
>
> — ANONYMOUS PARENT

> I still have PTSD whenever I have to go to court about something, even to renew my drivers license. It was SEVEN years of reliving everything that happened in the three years we were together.
>
> — ANONYMOUS PARENT

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

This dark, greedy, ego-driven system has crushed my children's innocence, obviated their ability to trust any adult, removed them from safety, and delivered them into the home of their predator. Instead of protecting my children from a manipulative, coercive, abusive parent, this system has invested its resources into gaslighting my young children and severing them from the only adult who has been brave enough to advocate for them in the face of years of threats and harm.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

It destroyed me emotionally and psychologically. It destroyed the innocence of three little girls. It took them away from their families, their friends, their schools and their two brothers. Their grandfather had a stroke while all this was going on and his last wish was to get those girls home. He died, knowing that his granddaughters were in Foster Care being molested by a 40+ year-old man. It has destroyed my daughter emotionally and made her drug use hundred times worse. It has affected every single person in our family.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

The prolonged proceedings in Duplin County have caused significant emotional and financial hardship for me over the years. The ongoing conflict and repeated court involvement have contributed to anxiety, stress, and instability for both myself and the minor child.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

This custody battle has taught me that protecting children is not about winning against the other parent; it is about preserving stability, truth, and peace when conflict tries to rewrite the story. I will keep choosing documentation over drama, boundaries over bitterness, and my children’s well-being over public revenge.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

The court has caused undue emotional stress on my young child, and myself. Leading to my child self harming and acting out at school due to not wanting to be with her father despite the courts failure to acknowledge evidence

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

The coordinated actions of these state and private actors mirror the elements of a federal criminal conspiracy (18 U.S.C. § 241) to deprive me & my daughter of our constitutional rights and exploited my family for pecuniary gain. I have meticulous documentation of these crimes, including the unlawful "self-help" eviction from my home and the theft of my personal property, perjury, obstruction of justice and stonewalling communication with me while working to ignore problems with other parent.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

This system weaponized a son’s choice against his family, imposing five years of baseless supervised visitation that fractured my relationship with my daughters despite there being no threat of danger.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

My son who is taking college courses in highschool is a good kid but has to endure his father's rage episodes where he has been strangled, pushed and father held my son down on the ground with his foot, banged his head on the desk, and threatened since 11 he would go to a foster home if he told police the abuse he was getting.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

The system has ruined my life I have PTSD and serve Depression I'm lost and have no purpose. My daughter's are having separation anxiety issues and my special needs daughter doesn't understand what happened but knows something isn't right and her medical needs are now a fight daily with my mother in law because I know whats best and what she needs. My girls love Me and my oldest daughter asks me daily if I am working on it?... meaning am I going to bring the ones who hurt us to justice.

— BRITTANY

My daughter is bonding with my mother for the last 4 months. This is a critical time for attachment development. Everyone involved including the safety provider and I'm nvestigator have said they know I am not a danger to Laken.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

> Took our autistic nephew form is caused depression caused him to to sneek ways to communicate we have not seen or heard from him in 3 years HE WAS 8 2 DAYS FORM BEING 9 AND HE IS NOW 12
>
> — ANONYMOUS PARENT

> This system has not protected my child and has torn apart my entire family. They have never listened to my child and they have been openly biased, played favorites, and lied under oath. It's a very sad world when whoever has the most money is the only person listened to. My child is the suffering major life long consequences and lives in fear daily.
>
> — LESLIE

> This system has nearly broken me as an individual. I have never understood how people coujd give up on life and commit suicide until going through this experience as well as have I never had the true feeling of hatred towards anyone in my entire life and it's been very difficult to not feel that.way towards these actors and perpetrators
>
> — DANIEL

> I trusted DSS with my first son. This time I gave temporary guardianship to my Aunt and allowed her to take my son to Fl I am in NC DSS has harassed me all day demanding I tell her to bring him back so they can make sure he's safe. They claim they as of 9:30 pm have been granted custody. One of the case workers is Jessica she literally text me at 3 am and said they are going to have my Aunt arrested for kidnapping. There was no court order (and I have yet to see one) when she left I just know they can't be trusted.
>
> — ANONYMOUS PARENT

> The system encouraged me to consent to a PC however gave me no choice in who I could use and has forced me to stay involved with AND pay a party who is clearly bias in regards to any interpretations of the order. I attempted to wait until the appointment was over rather than file motions to challenge PC decisions for the sake of peace and rather at a reappointment hearing, the PC was praised for keeping my family out of court. When I challenged that narrative the script was turned on me for not filing motions to challenge PC decisions. There is a documented pattern of preference. The PC substantially increased conflict in my family rather than lessen or resolve it.
>
> — ANONYMOUS PARENT

153 full approved North Carolina comments are included in this appendix.

07 HOW TO READ THIS REPORT

WHAT THIS IS

The Family Rights Registry is a public, parent-reported data collection run by Stand With Meg. Every figure in this North Carolina report comes from North Carolina respondents who voluntarily submitted survey entries about their experience inside family court and/or CPS.

This report is built to help families, advocates, reporters, and legislators see the patterns emerging in North Carolina — not to replace formal research, and not to name individual judges or counties as responsible parties.

WHAT IT ISN'T

This is not a representative sample. Respondents self-select. The 236 North Carolina families reporting here are not the universe of North Carolina families in court — they are the families who found the survey, trusted it enough to submit, and told us what happened to them.

Financial figures are self-reported. Response counts and percentages use the number of families who answered that specific topic or financial field. The Median Family Burden headline is the median of total reported expenses across families who reported in three or more expense categories. Quotes are minimally edited.

METHODOLOGY · FAMILY RIGHTS REGISTRY

Data in this report was collected April 2024 – October 2026 through standwithmeg.com/family-rights-survey. Submissions are timestamped. Duplicate-submission heuristics use normalized email + location, with direct survey rows preferred over legacy rows and the newest row retained within each source. Categorical responses from multi-select and short-answer fields are normalized monthly.

Dollar fields exclude blank, negative, and obvious data-entry artifact values above the report's field caps. When asset-loss values contain a strong statistical outlier, the asset-loss mean and total are suppressed and only the median is reported. Lost-wage, attorney-fee, and asset-loss entries are self-reported and not corroborated against tax records or court filings.

Geographic reporting uses the county or regional field as submitted, with light normalization (e.g. "Butte silverbow" → "Butte–Silver Bow"). Quotes carry one of three public permission states: *Anonymous*, *First-name only*, or *Full attribution with consent to public use*. Court actor names appear only after 3 independent families name the same actor.

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ABOUT THIS REPORT

This report is based on self-reported survey submissions collected by Stand With Meg. Counts and categories reflect responses available at the time this packet was generated.

This report is for informational and advocacy use only, not legal advice or an official government record.

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